

Who is **building this**

Two founders, a systems architect, a technical chief from the build partner, six advisors and a named engineering bench. Compliance software is bought on credibility before it is bought on features, which is why this page comes first.

2

FOUNDERS

6

ADVISORS, EACH WITH
A NAMED DISCIPLINE

2

HIRES THE ROUND
FUNDS, AND GATES

10

NAMED ENGINEERS AT
THE BUILD PARTNER

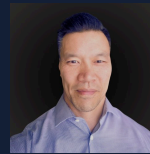
1 The people inside the company



Chad R. Johnston

FOUNDER AND CHIEF EXECUTIVE
4orm Finance

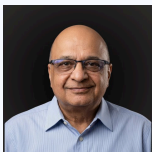
Life safety operations in oil and gas: procedure design, controls and rescue, where a missed step is a fatality and not a service ticket. Then six years building operational systems in Canadian financial education. He owns the customer relationship, the round and the scope.



Kevin Wong

CO-FOUNDER, GO TO MARKET
4orm Finance

Twenty two years scaling companies across several industries as a founder and fractional chief marketing officer. Positioning, the channel programme and market expansion are his.



Zahiruddin Sandeela

SYSTEMS ARCHITECTURE
TOGAF 9.1 and ITIL V3

Twenty years architecting regulated systems: Interac payments modernisation, money laundering compliance at Vancity, and systems work at WorkSafe BC, where the controls carry statutory health and safety weight. Owns target state architecture and the control framework.



Mathew Mozaffari

STANDING IN AS TECHNICAL CHIEF
Founder and chief executive, Speer Technologies

Founded Speer in 2019, named to BetaKit's Developer 30 Under 30 and a G20 delegate three times. He holds the technical seat while the build runs, which is how the company carries a chief technology function without carrying the salary.

One thing this bench has that most financial technology teams do not.

For two of us, controls used to be life safety: oil and gas rescue on one side, WorkSafe BC on the other. A control either holds under load or it does not exist.

The two hires the round funds, and the bench behind them

Nothing is built before both hires are in place, because a developer must never make a regulatory decision and neither must a model.

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Engineering lead

OPEN, AND THE ROUND FUNDS IT
Negotiations underway

Owns the architecture and every component that only a senior hand may touch: the evidence store, the two dates and the submission binders. The technical seat is covered by the build partner until this hire is made, and the hire is what makes it permanent and internal.

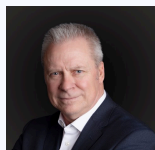
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Regulatory lead

OPEN, FRACTIONAL TO START
Search in progress

Authors and signs every rule release before it ships, and cannot deploy code. One per rule maker once the second regulator is live. The separation between the person who writes a rule and the person who ships code is cheap to design in now and close to impossible to retrofit.

2 Capital, from four separate people

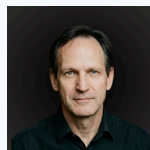


Bruce Fair

CAPITAL MARKETS

President, Mench Capital Corp.

Twenty five years structuring private and public equity. Mench Capital has originated or participated in over \$500 million of transactions. Institutional market access is his, and he orchestrates the round.

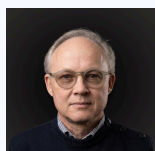


James Atherton

LEGAL AND CAPITAL MARKETS

Partner, Capiche Legal LLP

Twenty years advising growth stage companies on structuring, governance and exempt market financings. Owns founder structuring and the exempt market strategy.



Miika Makela

CAPITAL STRATEGY

Chartered Financial Analyst

Capital strategy and the investor facing model. Owns how the plan is priced and how it reads to a professional investor, which is a different discipline from raising the money.



Don H

ANGEL INVESTOR AND FIRST CHEQUE

Committed at incorporation

The first money into the company, at incorporation and already advanced. He carries no operating role, and he is here because an angel who committed before there was anything to see is part of the evidence.

Deliberately not the same person. Institutional access, exempt market structuring and how the plan is priced are different disciplines, and one advisor holding all of them would be a single point of failure on the most consequential file in the company.

Counsel, growth, and who comes inside

Two more advisors, each with their own standing outside this company and each owning one named thing inside it, and then the review dates.

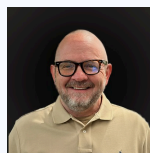


Michael Stephens

LEGAL COUNSEL, TECHNOLOGY

Partner, Fasken, Vancouver

Information technology law partner at Fasken, ranked in Best Lawyers in Canada for Information Technology Law and financial technology. Owns the corporate and securities framework.



Dean McCall

GROWTH STRATEGY

Startup advisor

Fifteen years partnering with founders, family offices and venture funds to move companies from concept to scale. Owns go to market sequencing and the technology leadership search.

Everyone on this page stays an advisor on the existing terms, and that is deliberate.

A small company that converts every advisor into an employee loses the thing that made the bench valuable: independent people with their own standing, saying what they actually think. Three people have a defined review date, and the rest do not.

3 Who comes into the company, and when

Person	Discipline	When it is decided
Kevin Wong	Go to market	Comes into the company with the round, on founder terms already documented: four year vesting with a one year cliff
Bruce Fair	Capital markets	Six month review falls due this month, backdated to the start of the engagement. The review decides the scope of a company role
Zahiruddin Sandeela	Head architect	Six month review in the first quarter of 2027. A role and an option package are considered at that point rather than promised now, because no option plan exists yet and the board has to adopt one first

Legend. Everyone else on these pages remains an advisor on the existing terms.

Counsel, on two files and from two firms

Legal work is split on purpose. One firm owns technology and the corporate and securities framework, the other owns founder structuring and the exempt market raise.

Firm	What they own	Why it matters to a customer	Why it matters to an investor
Fasken, Vancouver	Technology and the corporate and securities framework. Michael Stephens, partner, information technology	A regulated buyer's counsel asks who advised on the structure before they ask what the software does. A firm of Fasken's standing turns that from a diligence exercise into a reference check	Securities work on an exempt market raise is where first time founders most often create issues they cannot unwind. The structure, the agreements for future equity and the registered account eligibility were built with counsel from the start rather than remediated afterwards
Capiche Legal LLP	Founder structuring, governance and the exempt market raise. James Atherton, partner	The people selling to a regulated buyer are structured and governed properly, which is the first thing a procurement review of a young supplier looks for	The instrument and the raise sit with a partner who also builds financial technology, so the advice on the agreements for future equity comes from somebody who understands the product they are financing

Legend. Both firms are engaged in respect of 4orm Finance. Nothing in this document is legal advice from either firm to any reader, and nothing here is an endorsement by either firm of the business plan, the model or any forward looking figure in it.

4 What the bench is for, in one line each

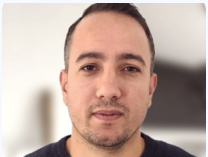
Regulatory and securities credibility	Two firms, one file each. Named partners rather than a firm name on a letterhead.
Capital markets depth, from two separate people	Bruce Fair on institutional access and orchestration, James Atherton on structuring and the exempt market. They are deliberately not the same person.
Regulated systems architecture, in house	Twenty years of it, including payments modernisation and a money laundering programme at a Canadian credit union. It is the reason the architecture note exists before the build does.
An engineering bench that has shipped in both hard places	Regulated Canadian institutions, and the digital asset infrastructure companies our customers connect to. That is a different proposition from hiring generalist contract developers and teaching them the domain.

At pre-seed the bench is the proof.

It is the reason a first customer takes the meeting, and the reason a reviewer reads the architecture note rather than asking for a demonstration.

Speer Technologies, the engineering bench

Ten seats across product, engineering, protocol, infrastructure, security and cryptography, nine of them carrying a name and the tenth a lead design role.

 Diego Castro Director of product	 Karan Agrawal Director of engineering	 Sid Bounadji Engineering manager	 Jad El Kassar Protocol engineer	 Harley Lovitos Smart contract architect
 Mike Glover Internet of things and infrastructure	 Eric Shin System integration engineer	 Doug Sutherland Blockchain protocol advisor	 Ahmed Nassri Security and cryptography advisor	 Product designer Lead user experience and interface strategy

Names, faces and titles as they appear in Speer's own partnership document. Named on the statement of work rather than promised as a capacity: a bench that is named can be checked, and a bench that is described cannot.

5 Where that bench has already delivered

TOKENY	FIREBLOCKS	BITGO	ALCHEMY	CUMBERLAND	CAMH	TORONTO MET	MARS
DMZ	OCI	ICTC	WALMART	COSTCO	MCDONALD'S	HARVARD	BERKELEY

1 Digital asset infrastructure

Tokeny, Fireblocks, BitGo, Alchemy and Cumberland cover the compliance token, custody, key management and node infrastructure end of the market our customers already use.

2 Canadian institutional delivery

CAMH, Toronto Metropolitan University, MaRS, the DMZ, the Ontario Centre of Innovation and ICTC. Procurement, privacy review and security assessment inside Canadian institutions is its own discipline.

3 Enterprise scale

Walmart, Costco, McDonald's, Harvard and Berkeley matter less for the names than for what they imply: systems that survive real volume and real uptime expectations.

How the engineering engagement is structured

A phased statement of work with published hourly rates and a fixed payment schedule. The structure is what protects 4orm Finance: each phase has a defined deliverable and a one month termination right without penalty, so the relationship is re-decided at every stage rather than committed once at the start.

Phase	Fee	Hours and duration	What it produces
1, discovery and architecture	\$20,600 to \$31,200	160 to 240 hours over one to two months	Requirements, stakeholder discovery, journey mapping and a requirements document defining scope and success criteria before engineering begins
2, design and development	\$62,400 to \$93,600	480 to 720 hours over three to five months	A functional build of the core pipeline, validated against real institutional workflows and integrations
3, continued development	\$104,000 to \$156,000	800 to 1,200 hours over three to six months	Expansion to a production ready platform with the operational, compliance and security frameworks institutional adoption requires

Legend. Rate card: engineering manager \$150 an hour, senior designer \$140, full stack engineer \$130, protocol engineer \$100. Engineering cost of \$187,000 to \$280,800 across the three phases, twenty five per cent on deposit and the balance in twelve equal monthly instalments, amendable by mutual written agreement and terminable by either party on one month's notice without penalty.

What the plan carries, against what the statement of work covers.

The master pro forma carries **\$825,000** of external engineering across 2026 and 2027, and **\$6,736,391** across the whole plan, on a base price that steps once and then runs as a falling share of revenue. The statement of work above covers the first phases of that, not all of it.

6 Two things to settle before the deposit

1 The deliverables are being rescoped

The statement of work predates the current build specification, and its deliverables are being rewritten against the evidence engine before any deposit is paid. The phase structure, the rate card and the termination terms are unaffected. This is a scoping exercise rather than a renegotiation.

2 Sales tax should be confirmed

The statement of work applies thirteen per cent harmonised sales tax, the Ontario rate for the supplier. 4orm Finance is Alberta incorporated, and place of supply rules for services supplied to an Alberta recipient will generally attract five per cent instead. On the upper bound that is roughly twenty two thousand dollars, and it should be confirmed with the accountant before the deposit.